

Speaker 1 [00:00:06] Do you have a particular name or word with which you want us to refer to your partner, such as boyfriend, spouse, partner, companion? Is there something you are most comfortable with?

Speaker 2 [00:00:17] Yeah, I like "companion."

Speaker 1 [00:00:18] Companion? How long have you been with your companion?

Speaker 2 [00:00:24] Almost [20-25] years.

Speaker 1 [00:00:26] Very well. Listen, I would like to start by asking you to tell me about your love story, the relationship you are currently experiencing.

Speaker 2 [00:00:36] That I am currently experiencing with him?

Speaker 1 [00:00:38] Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:00:39] Well, we are in the fullness of a relationship. In that sense, we know each other well, we've been through trials, we've built things together, we have founded a family. Our children are growing up, and we have successfully raised our [1-5] children, I must say. In our intimate life, we have grown closer, more complicit, so rather the fullness.

Speaker 1 [00:01:09] The fullness.

Speaker 2 [00:01:16] With ups and downs. Fullness is a strong word, but there is that aspect. Then there are ups and downs, of course, but that's the first word that came to me. So, I say it anyway.

Speaker 1 [00:01:24] Ups and downs, you say.

Speaker 2 [00:01:26] Also. Yes, yes, yes, there are sometimes tensions, inevitably, it's not always... That is to say, in daily life, the stress... We had a minister at the time who had a kind of administrative phobia. And I am a bit like that, so I think that as a result, my partner, my companion, carries a bit of that on his shoulders and it's not always easy. So, I am a bit more carefree, I admit in my life. He is a bit more rational, so there is a slight imbalance at that level, I admit willingly.

Speaker 1 [00:02:04] Well, I am really sorry, but it is cutting out a lot.

Speaker 2 [00:02:07] Ah darn, then I have to move elsewhere. So yeah, I'll try... I'll see, I'll walk around. Then tell me if when I get closer... I'm sorry. Can you hear me?

Speaker 1 [00:02:31] I can hear you.

Speaker 2 [00:02:34] I will try to go under the pine trees.

Speaker 1 [00:02:37] That seems better indeed.

Speaker 2 [00:02:40] Or at our neighbors', they are not here and I don't think they will mind. Can you hear me better there?

Speaker 1 [00:02:47] I can hear you very well.

Speaker 2 [00:02:50] Ah great, then I'll stay here. OK. Well, it's all good. Let's go, here we go!

Speaker 1 [00:02:56] There are no problems with people around you. Are you comfortable in this place? Did you hear me?

Speaker 2 [00:03:09] Perfectly, our neighbors are gone for the day, so [Inaudible].

Speaker 1 [00:03:16] Well, actually it's worse.

Speaker 2 [00:03:17] I am on their [location], no problem.

Speaker 1 [00:03:19] Actually, it's worse. I could hear you when you arrived on the [location], and now when you are inside, I can't hear you at all.

Speaker 2 [00:03:29] Damn. So [partner] was actually inside. I [Inaudible]. I will try to move a little more there. [Inaudible] terrace. There, can you hear me well now?

Speaker 1 [00:03:47] I think as soon as you go inside...

Speaker 2 [00:03:53] Can you hear me?

Speaker 1 [00:03:53] I can hear you.

Speaker 2 [00:03:57] [Note: speaking to partner] So he can't hear me. When I am too close to the sea, he can't hear me, when I am next to it he can't hear me either. I can't sit in the sun either, because he can hear me well when I am here, a little in the middle. How to do it? Then we will try another test. I am sorry. And now, is it? ... Now I can hardly do better. Is it okay, can you hear me?

Speaker 1 [00:04:35] I hear you very badly to be honest. Maybe it's not a big deal, maybe you should go back where you were, it's not a big deal, that was the best we had.

Speaker 2 [00:04:49] [Note: speaking to partner] I don't think it's a volume issue. It was still better in front where I was at the beginning?

Speaker 1 [00:04:54] I imagine, yes.

Speaker 2 [00:04:58] I am going back. It's not a big deal, I am next to it. Plus I can't go inside because we are cleaning. If it's really not good, I am available all next week, I am on vacation so. Maybe I can stand, I don't know. And now how do you hear me? Can you hear me now?

Speaker 1 [00:05:38] Now, it's really a disaster. But actually, you can see, you normally have a little...

Speaker 2 [00:05:45] I don't have anything, I have "Started recording", it doesn't say I have a bad network for now, it doesn't say anything. It's crazy because I can hear you very well. It's very clear.

Speaker 1 [00:06:03] Yes. Well listen, I am a bit embarrassed.

Speaker 2 [00:06:07] Or maybe I should try with headphones. Maybe my audio isn't very good, right?

Speaker 1 [00:06:18] No, I don't think so.

Speaker 2 [00:06:20] No, at times you hear me better.

Speaker 1 [00:06:22] In fact, there is really - already yes - and the zoom really indicates that the bandwidth is low on your side, meaning you have a bad network.

Speaker 2 [00:06:35] We will try to go a little further. I will stay in confidential areas, but I will try to move a little further. And now, can you hear me better?

Speaker 1 [00:06:54] A little bit.

Speaker 2 [00:06:55] Yeah, a little better? I am a little closer now.

Speaker 1 [00:07:02] Yes, yes, it seems a bit better. But you won't stay standing for the entire interview.

Speaker 2 [00:07:08] No, but it's not a big deal. We will do our best, and if it is really bad... If you don't mind calling me back, I don't know what is possible for you.

Speaker 1 [00:07:20] I think we will do that. I think it is not possible for you to stay standing for 1 hour, 1 hour and 15 minutes. Let's be realistic.

Speaker 2 [00:07:28] Well, it doesn't matter. But it's more about you, if you can't hear me well, it's going to be tough. Shall we try, continue and see?

Speaker 1 [00:07:41] It seems okay to me.

Speaker 2 [00:07:43] Well, okay, it's going to be fine, it works.

Speaker 1 [00:07:46] Can't you bring the chair you were sitting on?

Speaker 2 [00:07:50] Yes! I'll get it. People must think she is "completely crazy". (laughing) "She keeps going back and forth" (laughing). It's too funny. (laughing) Well, I need to find the spot, it doesn't take much.

Speaker 1 [00:08:21] No, but it is relatively acceptable now.

Speaker 2 [00:08:23] Well, good. Alright, let's go. Let's go! So, is it good now?

Speaker 1 [00:08:40] It's very good, it will do. If there are really any problems, I will tell you.

Speaker 2 [00:08:43] Okay, that works.

Speaker 1 [00:08:47] You were in the middle of - ah... Speak a little bit to see?

Speaker 2 [00:08:53] Yes, well I am waiting for you to prompt me.

Speaker 1 [00:08:56] It's good, it's good. There was a small cut. I wanted to make sure everything was fine. Yes, so you were telling me about your relationship of fullness, but with ups and downs, you said.

Speaker 2 [00:09:13] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:09:14] Maybe you could start by telling me about the meeting and how the meeting happened.

Speaker 2 [00:09:22] Well, it happened, I was [26-30]. A friend of mine told me she was invited to a party by one of her colleagues, she was a [occupation] and her colleague - so it was [partner] - invited her to a party. And she knew I was more or less single, I say more or less because I had met someone, it was an older man with whom it was a bit complicated, he wasn't around anyway. So she told me to come with her and I thought why not after all. And then at that famous party, it was in [Month] [Year] that we met. And then [partner] never giving up, well never giving up, being someone quite persistent, he followed up, he immediately asked for my number - it was the beginning of mobile phones. He even came to see me at the [company] where I worked at the time. I worked in a [company]. He left letters in my [redacted]. Well, someone who is immediately very present in your life, you know. And I liked that. That's it.

Speaker 1 [00:10:43] Yes?

Speaker 2 [00:10:46] And there you go. And gradually, the relationship with the other person fell apart. (laughing) We talk a lot about deconstruction, well that relationship fell apart and the one with [partner] was built at the same time. And little by little we got closer and a few months later, I was pregnant. So there you go, it went quite fast.

Speaker 1 [00:11:12] If I understand correctly, you met him at a party and he courted you first.

Speaker 2 [00:11:21] Yes, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:11:23] And you quickly moved in together, in fact.

Speaker 2 [00:11:28] Yes. Yes, yes, he is someone very enterprising. And things happen quickly with him, quite naturally. He has that talent. And I was also in my body, in a phase of... I

don't know how to tell you. I wanted to start a family. I felt that growing in me, and I think I felt that with him, it would be possible. That's it.

Speaker 1 [00:12:03] Yes, tell me?

Speaker 2 [00:12:04] No, no, I was saying it happened faster than expected. The family. But there you go, I had this feeling in my gut that he could be a father. It's hard to explain.

Speaker 1 [00:12:18] You said it happened faster than expected.

Speaker 2 [00:12:19] Yes, yes, it did happen quickly.

Speaker 1 [00:12:25] So if I understand correctly, you got together. You got pregnant a few months later.

Speaker 2 [00:12:30] Yes, that's it.

Speaker 1 [00:12:33] I would like you to tell me a bit about what happened next, the continuation of the story.

Speaker 2 [00:12:37] Well, the continuation is that [child] was born in... So we met in [Month]. On [Month] [Day], I took my pregnancy test and [child] was born on [Month] [Day] [Year]. And it was immediately clear that he was made to have children. I was not wrong and that this family was being built quite well in a... Well, we changed apartments, we took a place in an area we liked in [city], close to the forest, we had a triplex, it was some pretty... We were still going out quite a bit. We were still in adolescence, in youth - we were [26-30] - we were partying quite a lot and at the same time we were parents. Not irresponsibly, just the right amount. Young, dynamic, good. And we always progressed together, meaning both professionally, in our projects. And we took our time afterward to have a second child since we waited [6-10] years between [child] and [child]. And between those stages, there were periods where there were difficulties in our couple, where I think we came close to separating. There were things that deeply hurt me. It took years to forgive, I think. I never forgot, but I forgave. So there you go. And then [child] in [Year]. So there you go.

Speaker 1 [00:14:32] I - sorry, I am listening to you?

Speaker 2 [00:14:37] I hope you don't hear the [insect] too much. They just started singing.

Speaker 1 [00:14:41] No, it's really not a problem, the [insect].

Speaker 2 [00:14:44] Yes, so [child] in [Year], there you go.

Speaker 1 [00:14:49] You talked to me about the relationship you have with [partner]. If you had to compare the quality of this relationship, your couple relationship with that of your friends. What would you say?

Speaker 2 [00:15:08] I would say that... How could I say? There is still a balance. It is fragile and we are always looking for it. But we are still in a relatively balanced relationship and above all, we have always, always - maybe because of his job and maybe also because I am someone who needs to express myself, who was raised like that - but we talk a lot in our couple. So I would say we are a couple with no taboos. And we say things to each other - sometimes with the vehemence that he can have and that I can also have with my character - but we don't keep things to ourselves and we move forward together.

Speaker 1 [00:16:01] If I understand correctly...

Speaker 2 [00:16:05] So uh...

Speaker 1 [00:16:05] No, no, I am listening to you. There is sometimes a small delay, which is why it is complicated for me. Sometimes I will interrupt you, but it's your speech that interests me.

Speaker 2 [00:16:13] Yes, I understand. And there you go, it's true that we are in - and then I believe that we have, we have overcome trials together, we have grown together. In fact, we are a couple that evolves. There were sometimes differences, maybe a bit in timing on professional progress. But in the end, we are still challenging each other. When I redid my [educational attainment] in [Year], [Year] and [Year], in [Year], well, it doesn't matter. The following year, he completed his [University Degree] in [topic] because I think that in turn... Well, we challenge each other, but in a good way.

Speaker 1 [00:17:10] If I understand correctly what you are saying, it is that, compared to other couples, you have, what appears to you is a very present communication, and things that go in the same direction, meaning you support each other in your professional evolutions, and they are also often quite simultaneous.

Speaker 2 [00:17:30] Yes, it's true. Absolutely.

Speaker 1 [00:17:37] Are there other things that you see in the quality of your relationship compared to those of your friends?

Speaker 2 [00:17:46] I think we also function... We are several things. We are lovers, that's important. We are friends, in the true sense of the word friendship, meaning being there for the other, helping, supporting... And we are parents, we are father and mother, so we also... We have several facets, and we have enriched them at every moment of our life. So we are a multidimensional couple, there you go.

Speaker 1 [00:18:32] Multidimensional.

Speaker 2 [00:18:37] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:18:38] You mean both friends and lovers?

Speaker 2 [00:18:41] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:18:43] That's something you don't necessarily find in your friends' couples.

Speaker 2 [00:18:48] No, at least not in this complicity and closeness, no.

Speaker 1 [00:18:56] You talk about complicity and closeness.

Speaker 2 [00:18:59] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:19:04] If you had to do the same thing, but this time, not with your friends' couples, but with your previous relationships. That is, compare the quality of the couple you have now with that of your previous relationships, what would you say?

Speaker 2 [00:19:22] I would say the richness, the richness of what we have with [partner]. The daily life is never - well it's inevitably a bit [inaudible] it's been [20-25] years - but still, the daily life is not dull, not boring. I don't know, we renew ourselves, it is renewed. We like to laugh about many things. In my other relationships, after a while, I found it became monotonous, it became monotonous. And then, I think he is the man who takes the most - well, who has a way of taking care of me that no other man has brought me. So I mean this feeling of being very protected. He is someone very enveloping - sometimes maybe too much. Fortunately, I think I know, I know a bit - because we always have the flaws of our qualities, in the sense that he is very, very caring. He has a real... He is quite altruistic. And I find that the men I was with didn't have this selflessness that [partner] can have, for example. And then our relationships were less rich, less dense and less exciting than the one I have experienced with [partner] since [Year].

Speaker 1 [00:20:57] You talked about feeling protected and the selflessness that your companion could have, I would like you to tell me more about it.

Speaker 2 [00:21:08] Well [partner] is someone who... When he loves, he is... Well, I mean, I know very well that he gives everything. He is very, very generous. He is someone who will think of you first, well it's a detail but in the morning - I will sound a bit like a spoiled little girl here - but I mean he has everything ready, my coffee is ready... Without me asking him for anything! He does it naturally. He is someone who will do things for you, who will take care of you. He will carry your things, he will go get you if I am tired, the groceries, he will go quickly. Well, I don't know, things like that you see. It's full of little everyday things. So the distribution of tasks has been very balanced in our couple for a long time, you know. He never said "she's a woman". My generation is still a bit older than yours. (laughing) And maybe in other couples, men were less interested in household chores. But that is not the case with us. We have a balance already, and it's the same with the children. He takes care of them, he is present, he is present for the other, really. For the other and to the other.

Speaker 1 [00:22:35] You said he is present - no, I am listening to you.

Speaker 2 [00:22:39] It's really... It is verified daily. He is someone who - then, we must be careful too, that's where I, at times, if you want, it is the ease. I think it's no coincidence, my

father took care of me a lot, he was very present in my life, he took great care of me. Already for the time he was quite... Well, he was very present with his daughters and especially me, who was the youngest. So I think I like being taken care of, I admit. After, I am not into wallowing, it's not that. But still, it's important for me, it's true. But what we must also do anyway is to make sure there is no imbalance. Because at times, he gives a lot and then he waits. And I... I am not... I am generous, but not in the same way. I am in reciprocity, but I am not necessarily in quid pro quo. So that is something we have learned together, not always to expect from the other, otherwise don't do it. Sometimes [partner], I think he waits because he gives a lot. So there you go. You must try to keep that balance constantly. Sometimes he gives too much. Of his time, of his energy. I balance things a bit differently. It's true you have to be careful that the other doesn't take too much space in his life either. You must keep your free will and some space for your own reflection, your own desires.

Speaker 1 [00:24:29] Not taking up too much space.

Speaker 2 [00:24:30] Sorry?

Speaker 1 [00:24:31] You said, it is important that the other does not take up too much space.

Speaker 2 [00:24:34] Yes, yes, yes, it is important.

Speaker 1 [00:24:37] And you said a bit earlier "present for the other and to the other." What distinction do you make between these two terms?

Speaker 2 [00:24:49] Well, "present for the other", it's maybe this notion of generosity, altruism. And "to the other" it's just - it's me sometimes playing on words - but "to the other" for me, it's a bit "beside", "with", you see. It's with the other. Not just in seeking oneself with this abandonment to the other, it's with the other, we form a union, there you go.

Speaker 1 [00:25:28] Being available for the other. Being present beside.

Speaker 2 [00:25:35] That's it. Exactly. Without taking up the space of.

Speaker 1 [00:25:39] Meaning someone you can count on.

Speaker 2 [00:25:41] Yes, exactly, absolutely.

Speaker 1 [00:25:43] Knowing that he is present if needed.

Speaker 2 [00:25:46] Exactly. (emphatically)

Speaker 1 [00:25:48] I would like to know, I would like you to tell me about what a high-quality relationship is for you.

Speaker 2 [00:25:57] A high-quality relationship... I think it is a relationship in which there is a notion of fulfillment. Meaning the person grows, becomes better - when I say better, it's in well-being, in... They are enthusiastic. They are accomplished. There is a form of self-fulfillment. And

they give to the other. Well, I mean, they share their happiness and they also allow the other to be happy in the same way. It's a kind of virtuous circle. Yes. That's what a high-quality relationship is for me.

Speaker 1 [00:27:00] So a high-quality relationship for you is a relationship that makes the other grow, self-fulfillment of the other.

Speaker 2 [00:27:07] Yes. We grow and make the other grow. And we fulfill ourselves and make the other, through that, better - well, better... good - there is a form of mutual fulfillment in that.

Speaker 1 [00:27:23] A form of mutual fulfillment.

Speaker 2 [00:27:25] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:27:28] How can we know we are in such a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:27:37] That's a very good question. I would say it's when we feel that daily life, despite the troubles, life, the ups and downs, in the end, we will get through things with a certain ease and we still keep a certain... I don't know how to say it. Joy of living, when we feel good in the morning, when we are next to the other, when we don't look at our partner with indifference or worse with disgust. When we laugh together too. Laughter is very important to me. The fact of having times where we share a laugh, we share complicity. We laugh at something, he makes me laugh, I make him laugh, we don't take ourselves too seriously. I consider that... I don't remember what we said (laughing) I don't know if (laughing) I am digressing. I don't know if it answers the question, actually.

Speaker 1 [00:28:45] What I was saying is how we can know we are in such a relationship that you describe. That is, a fulfilling relationship, where there is a dynamic where each pulls the other up.

Speaker 2 [00:29:01] When we smile, when we feel good, when we feel that the days don't weigh a ton, when we don't feel like we are dragging our feet in the mud and our heads are heavy, but rather when we still have a form of... When we have energy, you see... For me, I consider we are in such a relationship. When we like to move forward and start the day earlier.

Speaker 1 [00:29:35] When would you say your relationship has been the most fulfilling as you describe?

Speaker 2 [00:29:42] I would say currently. In these recent years. Since, I would say our last project, it's when we acquired a [house] in [Year], just before the lockdown, which saved our lives by the way. I don't know if I could say the same thing now, I don't know if we would still be together, I don't know. And we spent the lockdown as [1-5] in this new house and I discovered a new side of him. Meaning he surprised me again in the sense that he fulfills himself, he loves working the land, he loves... He made us, how to say... He worked the land to make terraces for

us, he planted, we did the interior work, I contributed quite a bit. And then we have a sex life that is better than before, yes, for the past [1-5] years. [Inaudible]

Speaker 1 [00:30:48] A life that is better than before, you say?

Speaker 2 [00:30:51] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:30:54] In what way?

Speaker 2 [00:31:01] In what way. Well... I feel more comfortable, surprisingly, with my desires, my body, my desires, and... There you go, we allow ourselves more things together, we are more playful.

Speaker 1 [00:31:33] Conversely, when would you say this relationship has been the least fulfilling?

Speaker 2 [00:31:41] A few years after my daughter was born, in [Year] and [Year], yes, there were things... I see time passing. Yes in [Year], yes, [Year], in [Year] particularly. We were no longer quite on the same wavelength, him. I think he needed to, to... [redacted].

Speaker 1 [00:33:36] You talk about this forgiveness, I would like you to tell me more, how did you manage to forgive?

Speaker 2 [00:33:50] Well... I think we left. We left [city] [6-10] years ago. Yes, it's been almost [6-10] years. We left with [child] who was [1-5] years old, the eldest who was [11-15], and him who was [1-5]. And we went to [city] for [1-5] years. So there, we no longer had family around, friends, so we made a union, if you will, in a city where we knew no one. At first, we had to start all over again. He had a job. I had to find a job and there I think somehow, we... There is a form of union, of reunion that happened where we finished unifying our family and I think that leaving maybe allowed me to heal the wounds a bit, yes. And to heal. And so changing the setting, going into other projects, me too, starting something new. I believe forgiveness came at that time, yes. In a different context.

Speaker 1 [00:35:15] If I understand correctly, what you are saying is that being in a different context allowed you almost to start something different and to leave behind things associated with other contexts.

Speaker 2 [00:35:26] Yes, yes. I think it helped a lot, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:35:32] Eum - yes you were going to say something?

Speaker 2 [00:35:34] No, no, no, no, no, no, no, it's fine. No, it's fine. Sometimes I...

Speaker 1 [00:35:38] Don't hesitate.

Speaker 2 [00:35:40] Yes, it works.

Speaker 1 [00:35:43] You talked to me about what a high-quality relationship is for you, a fulfilling relationship, a relationship where each pulls the other up. Now I would like you to tell me what a low-quality relationship is for you.

Speaker 2 [00:35:59] It's when there is no sharing. It's when you are next to the other and you are interested in nothing about the other, you share nothing. You think only of yourself and only of yourself. When there are no projects, there is no exchange, there is no conversation. There are no moments spent together, not even I mean in the intimate relationship, there is no pleasure, there is no... When the other, in fact, gives nothing, transmits nothing and there, in this relationship, there is no exchange at all. In nothing. For me, it's really, that's the worst. And then, of course, the worst is the betrayal of the other and openly, regularly, disrespecting the other, treating the other in a degrading manner. Yes, being physically violent, morally... Yes, all that. For me, that's a low-quality relationship, to put it mildly.

Speaker 1 [00:37:41] You talk about a low-quality relationship which would be a relationship without sharing, without a common vision, without respect with lies and betrayal. In the same way, how can you know you are in such a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:37:57] I think it's when you are in self-withdrawal when already - our body speaks, I believe in that a lot. When the person has pain everywhere, when already they feel bad in their body, it means something is wrong. When the person withdraws and has little interaction with others, they are in a form of solitude, they are isolated or when they never smile or very little. When they cry. When they don't express themselves, when they don't talk. When they are suffering, when they feel bad in their body. Yes, I think all that are very strong indicators, very strong signals.

Speaker 1 [00:38:58] You talked to me about what a low-quality and high-quality relationship is for you. And I would like you to talk about things, if there are others, that are most important for you in a romantic relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:39:20] Well, for me, in any case, it is important to have projects with others, meaning to project yourself, the idea of projecting yourself, going towards a common goal, that seems... It can be starting a family, starting a business, I don't know, whatever. But having a common goal seems very important to me. Having a fulfilling intimate life and it seems an important criterion. Being able to have complicity at every moment, having no embarrassment on any subject, being able to laugh about almost anything. That's what I would say. And then, holding hands.

Speaker 1 [00:40:27] Holding hands.

Speaker 2 [00:40:28] In all contexts of life. In easy moments where it's not too hard and in difficult moments. When we have to face trials and the other is there, present. Next to, beside, with.

Speaker 1 [00:40:47] You mentioned a certain intimacy. What do you mean by this intimacy?

Speaker 2 [00:40:56] The intimate relationship, yes, sexual, having a fulfilling sexuality, yes. Really, I believe. Being able to have games, whatever they are, of course being consensual on both sides, but there you go. And being able to take as much pleasure in verbal jousting, as in sexual games, yes. That seems to be... Bodies and minds being in harmony. That seems good to me.

Speaker 1 [00:41:31] Bodies and minds in harmony. You see a desirable match there.

Speaker 2 [00:41:39] Oh yes, yes. Really.

Speaker 1 [00:41:45] You mentioned it a bit earlier in the interview and I would like you to talk, based on your experience, about what love is for you.

Speaker 2 [00:41:59] Love is... I often come back to bodies, but I really believe it makes you vibrate, love. It is something that makes your heart beat faster. When the person is not there, you feel the lack. You feel bad, you are not well. Love is when you realize that when you are only yourself, something is missing, actually. In fact, love is like discovering the universe. I don't know how to explain it. It is apprehending the world completely differently with another perspective. It is realizing that... Well, we are good with the person, that we are better with this person than alone. And then it is seeing things in an augmented way. It's enhancing your strengths, increasing your... It is a form of self-fulfillment that is even more important. And really, it is the notion of saying at one point that, yes, we are good when we are two. That we are better, than alone. And we find that our universe is much more interesting with two than the one we have alone.

Speaker 1 [00:43:43] If I understand correctly, what you are saying is not only being good with the other, it is being better with the other.

Speaker 2 [00:43:50] Yes, it is being better with the other. Exactly. Because being good with the other, we can find that. In friendship, we can have complicity - and luckily it's great - but when we share someone's life - whether it is a man, a woman, two men, two women, it doesn't matter - but when we are really in love, we are better, we vibrate. There is a notion of vibration, really. And of lack if the person is not there and of enjoyment, of pleasure when they are there.

Speaker 1 [00:44:29] You would say it has what importance for you, love in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:44:34] It is crucial. I could not stay without love. Well, I am a lover, I am in love, yes, still. (strong emotion) It's not trivial, your [interview].

Speaker 1 [00:45:13] Please, go ahead.

Speaker 2 [00:45:27] We can, we can continue.

Speaker 1 [00:45:31] We know there are different forms and ways of loving, and I would like you to talk about how you know your partner loves you.

Speaker 2 [00:45:51] There are many things. First, I think he has a hard time when I am not with him, seeking my presence. He needs to touch me, to be close to me. He is attentive to my emotions, to my feelings. He has attention for me that makes me think he loves me, yes. Then he tells me (laughing) so I want to believe him. He tells me, he shows me, and he has many gestures of love. And I am not talking about gifts, I am talking about really making my daily life easier. Really, on many things, on many concrete actions. So these are little acts of love - well when I say little, every day acts of love, this form of attention he has constantly. The look he gives me that makes me a fulfilled woman at [46-50], and that I accept my gray hair whereas I wouldn't have done it, I think, if he wasn't there, if he didn't look at me with those eyes. Well, I have gained weight, obviously, I don't have the size [36-40] I used to have. So he still makes me feel beautiful, so I think there must still be some love in all that, in the way he looks at me.

Speaker 1 [00:47:27] I would like you to tell me about one of the last positive interactions you had with your companion.

Speaker 2 [00:47:36] Well, earlier we went swimming and in the water, we hugged and kissed.

Speaker 1 [00:47:47] I would also like you to tell me about one of the last negative interactions you had with your companion.

Speaker 2 [00:47:57] (laughing) [partner] is still someone who gets nervous. So he can get annoyed quickly, and there when he tidies up if it doesn't go his way, well, he will quickly raise his voice. I hate when people raise their voices. So that is a negative interaction, it's when the tone is raised, when he doesn't speak when I feel he is getting angry... There you go. He gets annoyed for nothing because we are about to leave and because every time we leave, he is like that, you know. More or less.

Speaker 1 [00:48:33] You talked about it, maybe mentioned some at the beginning of the interview, and I would like you to talk to me, according to you, about the challenges to be met in your relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:48:43] So, as it comes to mind, it will be seeing our children grow up and leave. Because in the end, we were very little the two of us - as you will have understood, a year later [child] arrived - and so it will be finding ourselves just the two of us. Just the two of us. And there you go, nurturing our couple. That's a challenge. Having still common projects because sometimes, with time, age, we can have different desires, maybe. For example, I want to travel a bit more, to go further than the travels we did. [partner] is someone who will now want to focus on something, well, the house, the garden. And I want to discover a bit more beyond. So we will have to manage to coexist with these variations, these differences. I have no doubt that communication works, it will never change. So we won't lose it. No, it's keeping common projects and always nurturing each other and reinventing ourselves, there you go, reinventing ourselves. And especially when at some point, we will find ourselves just the two of us. That's a challenge.

Speaker 1 [00:50:25] You have talked several times about communication. I would like you to tell me more about this notion that seems important to you.

Speaker 2 [00:50:37] I think it is very important, in a couple, more than important, even crucial, to be able to tell the other and to explain, and feelings, to illustrate them, to make them explicit. Not to say I am unwell - well it's good - but why am I unwell, what is wrong, and trying to be in interaction with the other to find common solutions when it doesn't go well. Because life is not linear, in any way. So if we don't tell the other why it doesn't go well or even what goes well! How can the other know - though there are things we can feel. But if we don't talk, if we don't exchange, the verbal communication, but communication is also in many unspoken things, of course, we must also be attentive to all that. But well, I am mostly talking about expression, it is important not to... How to say... To censor oneself. We must be able to say everything to the other because if we censor ourselves, if we prevent ourselves from saying things, at some point the relationship is truncated, it is distorted. And that can generate serious problems for the future. So there is a form of honesty sought through communication.

Speaker 1 [00:52:21] A kind of honesty which is also a way to know the other, as you describe it.

Speaker 2 [00:52:26] Exactly, yes. Absolutely.

Speaker 1 [00:52:29] To find a kind of match as well.

Speaker 2 [00:52:32] Exactly. Completely.

Speaker 1 [00:52:37] We know that sometimes, in a relationship, everything is not rosy. And I would like you to talk about the conflicts or disputes you can have with your companion.

Speaker 2 [00:52:54] They will mostly be about sometimes, it can be related to children, education, this more authoritarian side... On conflicts that will question the place of the other in relation to the child and their attitude towards the child. It can be on financial matters, though. That is to say "money wounds are not fatal", - we are not to be pitied either - but well, we still have a context that makes it an issue sometimes. We didn't have the same upbringing, so I think [partner] is someone who missed out a lot, he had a mother who was a spender, etc., so he is quickly scared. He quickly gets anxious. And I, on the contrary, had a family that knew a bit of wealth, quite a bit of wealth, then also some problems. But for me, I don't put the same things into money. So yes, that can generate conflicts for us. At times, he has anxieties that rise like that. And it is true that, at that moment, or then he has anger too that can start from not much. [Redacted].

Speaker 1 [00:54:47] Something quite eruptive.

Speaker 2 [00:54:49] Yes, eruptive. Like a volcano. And yet I think I can say roughly, but it's complicated. I already told him "You are a [occupation], I remind you," but we should be able to talk about it calmly with someone. There are things that go back a long way, very far. Like a volcano.

Speaker 1 [00:55:11] Like a volcano. I would like to know, roughly, you talk to me about these conflicts, how frequent they are over about [1-5] weeks.

Speaker 2 [00:55:28] Conflict is like a dispute? Or is it even higher for you?

Speaker 1 [00:55:33] What you consider. It can also be small clashes, you can distinguish between these three things.

Speaker 2 [00:55:37] Over the [11-15] days of vacation? Come on, let's say two... The first two days, we had to adjust a bit. There you go. Two disputes, yeah, two conflicts, yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:55:53] How do you resolve these conflicts, these disputes, or these small clashes?

Speaker 2 [00:56:01] At some point, one will try to make a step towards the other, seeking appeasement and finding a roundabout way to approach the other. So there, for [partner], it's very important to say, well, if it's me, let's say, who considers I was unfair, to go back to him, to have a gesture, a word. So there, immediately, it gets better. Sometimes I can't always when I consider it's not my fault, that I don't have to do it. So it can take a bit longer. But well, it will be through dialogue at some point or another. We will break the silence. Either him or me. We will make a move.

Speaker 1 [00:56:54] How long do you stay in conflict like that, how long does it take for, as you say, someone to break the silence?

Speaker 2 [00:57:04] The longest we've done might have lasted [1-5] days. [1-5] days, yeah. Very, very big conflicts. That was a very strong conflict.

Speaker 1 [00:57:20] And more generally?

Speaker 2 [00:57:22] Oh, it's a few hours.

Speaker 1 [00:57:27] Besides communication, approaching the other, which you describe as ways to resolve these conflicts, what are the other ways you maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:57:44] It's about sharing moments of intimacy. So, together, going to share, I don't know, a time if he is in the garden, I come to share something with him. I come to help him or I am with him for a moment. If it's to go my way, he will go for a walk with me. Or there you go, it's about entering the other's sphere of interest. That is important. I would say it's also about sharing your intimacy with friends, giving yourself moments where when you host friends or family, well, we are around a meal and we have a good time, and we talk and laugh about many things. Moments like that also, that bring us closer. It's about going on family vacations and creating memories, moments of complicity with our children, birthday parties, meetings with people... There you go. It's also about expanding our circle of friends. We are people who are both curious. I didn't say that, by the way, but this is the opportunity to say it. Curiosity, the interest we can have in others. We have that in common. It expresses itself in different ways,

but what makes it that, therefore, we, we don't just live with the people we - we have people we've known for a very long time - but we expand the circle. We are not exclusive. We are also generous in that. And that, that is also part of this enrichment, of stimulation in the couple. Do you see what I mean? Discovering other people together, introducing other people into our sphere, sharing other moments, whatever. And then... Remind me of your question because sometimes I feel like I go far.

Speaker 1 [01:00:16] Please. Answer what seems relevant to you. It was about understanding the ways in which you maintain your relationship.

Speaker 2 [01:00:27] Yes, well there you go. Curiosity. And then, spicing up your life, spicing up your life. Now, I am a coward. But for example, for some, it will be perhaps doing some extreme sports, having strong sensations in terms of sports. Well, that's not my case because I'm a coward, but as a result, I spiced up my sex life, thanks to him. He opened me up to things I wouldn't have dared. I was a bit, maybe more... Although. Anyway, there you go. We spiced up our life. Love, sexual. That too, is important.

Speaker 1 [01:01:13] If I understand correctly what you are telling me about this notion of curiosity, there is this idea of having this entity as a couple and then bringing in external elements into this sphere you are describing to me, into this entity, to both observe them, share with them, finally adding something, increasing something.

Speaker 2 [01:01:33] Yes. Exactly. That is to say that the couple must be self-sufficient - that's very good, it's a strength - but not only. It must be open, it must not be - in my opinion - it must not live in a closed vase because otherwise it can wear out. So it needs to open up to others to enrich itself, to come back a little. It's like a system of flux and reflux.

Speaker 1 [01:02:03] It's important for you to be open.

Speaker 2 [01:02:05] Yes.

Speaker 1 [01:02:07] As a relational couple entity.

Speaker 2 [01:02:10] Yes.

Speaker 1 [01:02:14] I would like to know what could make you leave your partner.

Speaker 2 [01:02:21] What could make me leave my partner. (pause) What could make me leave [partner]. If I learned that he had betrayed me again and lied for months, years, that he has a double life, reviving something, that I think I couldn't bear. And then - but that's not possible there are things he would never do - that he's not there for his children, that's not possible, so I can't say that. Because I know he would do that. But yes, if there were betrayal, yeah. That could... A violent betrayal, I think I could leave him, yeah.

Speaker 1 [01:03:23] You talk to me about betrayal and lies. Do you mean this notion of betrayal of lies in adultery or is it something that is more global in the relationship and that could apply to other things for you?

Speaker 2 [01:03:35] Yes, it's for example yes, yes, it's more global. Yes, there is adultery, but there is also, for example, perspectives that we would have had - as we always project a lot - and that in the end, he disengages, doesn't show up, forces me to take a path while we... Well he forces me. That then he backtracks and disengages. And that somewhere, he betrays a project we had in common and that what he proposes to me is the opposite of what we had always based our projects on. So it can be about... About a life projection that is completely different from what he had announced and that at the last moment, there he says to me "Well no", things like that where he would really put me in a difficult position. Yeah. If it were recurrent and when we no longer understand each other. I think yes, in the long run, that could separate us. Distance us and separate us.

Speaker 1 [01:05:03] If I understand correctly what you are telling me, there is this idea of betrayal. It is actually betraying the implicit or explicit framework that has been built through the communication that is dear to you in understanding the other.

Speaker 2 [01:05:14] Yes, completely. Exactly.

Speaker 1 [01:05:19] Would you say that this relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2 [01:05:22] The relationship with [partner]? Oh yes, it is good for me, without hesitation. It allows me to have well-being, personal fulfillment as a woman. It allows me to be well with others, well in my body, well in my mind, overall. It allowed me to move forward in life as I told you at the beginning. So yes, this relationship is good for me, yes.

Speaker 1 [01:06:04] You talk to me about the fact that it helps you to be well in your body, with others, well in your mind. If I understand correctly, it's something that helps you regulate yourself, this relationship.

Speaker 2 [01:06:13] Yes, yes. Yes, yes. That also helps me to move forward where I might not have dared to do so. Our relationship is a booster. A way to not be in inertia, professionally too. When you're well in your couple, in your life, you can afford to go a little further in your professional projects. You can take the plunge, you can take on challenges that you wouldn't tackle if you're already not well in your own life, in your own life with the other in any case. It seems to me. So then, all that, being well in your couple. You move forward faster, further.

Speaker 1 [01:07:07] I would like you to give me examples if you have any in mind, of moments when this relationship helped you achieve your goals, personal or professional as you say.

Speaker 2 [01:07:35] Moments that helped me... Well, I think first of building a family with three children, a large family in quotes. It's because I think with another man, it wouldn't have been possible, with [partner] yes. He helped me pass my driving test because frankly, I wasn't very good, not very motivated. Again, the notion of constraint with me is still a real problem. So on

my own, I have certain problems with that. So he allowed me to lift constraints and helps me a lot in lifting constraints actually. I took on responsibility positions in the private sector and it wasn't always simple. He - it's still me who made the decision - but he still made it easier for me when I had to change employers and leave, he was of great support. (pause) When I lost my father, he was more than present. He carried my sorrow in fact.

Speaker 1 [01:09:20] He carried your sorrow.

Speaker 2 [01:09:20] So well, it's still a beautiful act of love.

Speaker 1 [01:09:32] You also mentioned to me that a good relationship for you is a relationship that helps you regulate yourself, do you have similar examples in this notion?

Speaker 2 [01:09:48] Regulate oneself. Well, I am still someone who is - well balanced may not be the term - but measured I think? I still have a strength in me that makes - but at work, at times, I can quickly sometimes... I could want to drop everything. Leave, start all over... Because it's not going as I would like or... And he still there, he can reason with me on certain things, he gives me perspectives, he puts things into perspective a lot. He prevents me from making impulsive decisions, as I might have done when I was younger with my first employers for example. But now, I am much wiser. Those are the things I think about. Then, in the relationship, I think it's more me who regulates him, in the sense of soothing him, allowing his moods not to be too variable, too high or too low. That was what I was thinking - me too, indeed - but there you go. He has a different contribution compared to me.

Speaker 1 [01:11:27] Yes, I hear what you are saying. I would like to know if you think you are the same person as before your current relationship, in other words, has this relationship changed you?

Speaker 2 [01:11:44] It all depends on what we mean. I would say that I have necessarily evolved, because before I knew him, I was a young woman, now I am a mature woman, established professionally. I am a mother of [1-5] children. I feel more fulfilled. More... How could I say. More mature, yeah. More maturity. More strength in me. I feel stronger. How could I say. I think I have grown, yeah. I have grown in many things.

Speaker 1 [01:12:48] Yes, in many things.

Speaker 2 [01:12:50] Yes, I have grown in the way of taking on life's events, in the way of apprehending the events that can happen, in building a relationship with the other. The way I view [Inaudible] The strength I also feel in myself. I feel much stronger today than when I met him, that's for sure. More assertive and structured. More sensual - I don't know if I can say it, but yes more sensual, surprisingly. A kind of fulfillment of the body, also. Not just of the mind.

Speaker 1 [01:13:48] The relationship between the body and the mind.

Speaker 2 [01:13:50] I assume my body more now. Even though it is less perfect, less beautiful. At 25, I was a beautiful young woman, I think I can say that. And now, my body has

necessarily changed a little. And yet, I assume it more. I feel better in my body, surprisingly. While I know perfectly well that by classic beauty standards, it is less beautiful and yet I assume it more, and I find myself different and that's how it is. But I feel more in harmony with my body than I was before. And that comes from him.

Speaker 1 [01:14:39] That comes from him.

Speaker 2 [01:14:40] Yes.

Speaker 1 [01:14:42] You say you assume your body more. Do you also love it more?

Speaker 2 [01:14:47] Yes, in any case, I am more comfortable with it. Yes.

Speaker 1 [01:14:53] And regarding your partner, do you think he has changed during and compared to before the relationship?

Speaker 2 [01:15:01] Oh yes. Yes, yes. I find him more accomplished. Well, he has gained depth in the sense that he is someone who is well-grounded. I think... Yes, he is grounded. He has gained a kind of strength. Well, how could I put it. Yes a form of... I feel he is stronger. For example, in his work, he has lots of projects and I tell myself - then very modestly, he is the one who carries them - but we often say that behind every man is a woman. And there, I think I have brought a lot of balance, a lot of balance into his life. So as there are solid ties with me, with the children, we are still a very built, very strong family, he can necessarily embark on many other professional projects, that follow behind. When he comes home, he knows that he is well, I think. He knows he can count on me. I don't know if, for example, he needs to, to build something, to express an idea, sometimes send an email to his employer, he will ask for my opinion. So I correct. Sometimes he can be a bit - or he goes too far in the explanations, he gets lost. He writes very, very well, he is really very brilliant, but sometimes the excess is the enemy of the good. Sometimes, I tell him "no simpler, more, more clear, that will do". You see what I mean? So I think that therefore, yes, all these years spent like that. Yeah, he's a guy who is in full professional strength I think. Who could actually, he could do much bigger things, but he is quite modest, he doesn't have - I already told him "But if I had your psychology degree, I would", well. He likes to help people. He is not looking for glory, he really seeks to do good around him. I find that it shows in what he does. But well, if he can do all that, it's still because he is well in his couple, that's for sure.

Speaker 1 [01:17:27] A supportive relationship.

Speaker 2 [01:17:29] Yeah, yeah, yeah, yeah, I think so. Yes, that's for sure, solid.

Speaker 1 [01:17:35] What you described a little earlier.

Speaker 2 [01:17:36] I'm someone solid. Sorry?

Speaker 1 [01:17:38] No, I'm listening to you.

Speaker 2 [01:17:40] No, no, I was saying I am someone solid, so I think that... He sees that there is someone strong. For him, that's important. And then there is a form of solidarity between us. He knows that, there you go, he can talk to me about it if something is wrong, ask me for advice. I will always make sure to find the best solution for him. I will put myself in his place, I will try to position the problem, we will think together. And all that, it's still in a couple, it's important.

Speaker 1 [01:18:22] Who can rely on you, that's what you describe to me.

Speaker 2 [01:18:24] Yes, completely. There's also a notion... There's a word that crossed my mind. How could I say, when we are in mutual help like that. Maybe the term will come back to me. In a couple, there must also be this side, you know where... It's not companionship, but I'm looking for the term, it will come back to me, it's not important, but that idea matters, that we can count on the other. And there you go. And that the other is there and that there is someone strong. As you said, that's exactly it.

Speaker 1 [01:19:07] You can take the time to find that word that is important to you.

Speaker 2 [01:19:10] Yes, it will come back to me, I think.

Speaker 1 [01:19:17] Earlier in the interview, you had quite a strong emotion. I would like, if you agree, for you to explain it to me a little more. What provoked this emotion, why did you have it, where does it come from?

Speaker 2 [01:19:30] At what moment? Because I'm someone who - I'm sensitive as [partner] would say. (laugh) When we were talking about what? Because you know it's dense so...

Speaker 1 [01:19:45] It's when we were talking about the importance of love in a relationship.

Speaker 2 [01:19:52] Ah yes. Well yes, because... (strong emotion) I told myself that I could hardly live without him. It's quite vertiginous. As a feeling.

Speaker 1 [01:20:13] I'm listening.

Speaker 2 [01:20:19] That... When there's such a strong attachment that... You tell yourself "damn, if he wasn't there. Wow". I would want to continue, but it would be hard, that's it. That's love, actually, there's a feeling of vertigo. And then, to tell you everything, I'm afraid of heights. (laugh) So necessarily, it responds to a big, big anxiety. That's what it is. That's love. It's when the other, you say "yeah", when he takes the place he has but in fact, if I think about the reverse, it's if he wasn't there. That would be almost impossible." Especially when you live with someone who takes so much space. Finally, who takes all the space. Who takes all his space. The one I also let him take. Yeah, it's hot. He fills you up, so wow, you have to imagine the emptiness afterward.

Speaker 1 [01:21:25] Yes, I see. I hear what you're saying. Would you say that you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker 2 [01:21:39] Yes, yes. Now, I can say it. Yes, yes, yes, yes, I feel safe. Yes, totally.

Speaker 1 [01:21:54] And then?

Speaker 2 [01:21:55] Safe in the sense that I don't see much that could really shake our relationship's structure. We talked about what could be better earlier, but it's been [20-25] years, we've been through a lot of things. We are also in moments of life where we are accomplishing things on both sides. I feel safe with him, yes. Because of the love he gives me, which is strong. Because we have also built, of course. We are still at a point in our lives where we have our house, we have an apartment, we have our children who are growing up, who are studying, who are succeeding. There you go, I mean. Yes, the only thing that could catch us is illness. Things like that, but well. But otherwise, I have a feeling of security. I really feel him by my side.

Speaker 1 [01:23:16] Being safe can also mean the ability to open up to your partner about your experiences, thoughts, identity without fear of judgment.

Speaker 2 [01:23:28] Exactly. Yes, it's true that I saw the term security really in Maslow's pyramid way. (laugh) Yes, of course, we are really there. There's nothing I forbid myself regarding him. I don't know how to put it. There's nothing I hide from him, that I sweep under the rug, that I could hide from him about myself, about who I am... I'm never putting on a front, I'm myself at 200%, totally comfortable, totally me. Completely me, yeah. He makes me feel... Yeah, he gives so much confidence that I am... I have no fear actually. I have no fear of telling him what I feel, of telling him intimate things that may cross my mind... Yeah.

Speaker 1 [01:24:43] Telling him who you are.

Speaker 2 [01:24:46] Yes.

Speaker 1 [01:24:51] Feeling safe is also knowing that you can get comfort or attention from the other in case of danger or distress.

Speaker 2 [01:25:06] Yes. That's inherent in who he is, comfort and attention. That's [partner]'s matrix, that's his driving force. He is, he is like that. In fact, [Name], for him to be well, he has to do good, otherwise, it doesn't work. It's even sometimes... So when my father passed away, I mean he was... He looked at me, immediately he saw that I was not well, immediately he was there, responding, carrying my sorrow. This term, I found it with you, but it's exactly that. Finding the words, being attentive - then he already is. And then not just that, at some point, saying "OK, we've passed a phase. Now, it's time" and always in the right way, so that the other also at some point, comes out of their sorrow. And then he will say, "Look, look here, this is going well. Look, we will go there." He is someone who has really always found the right positioning in difficult moments, that very clearly. And who helped me overcome them, that's for sure.

Speaker 1 [01:26:41] To lighten them, as well.

Speaker 2 [01:26:47] To lighten them. Exactly. To lighten them and even to take them on himself. It's still a remarkable act of self-giving.

Speaker 1 [01:26:57] You told me that you could indeed be yourself, open up about who you are. Do you have an example of a moment when you were indeed able to open up to your partner or say who you were?

Speaker 2 [01:27:25] There are plenty of moments when we confide in each other, not long ago, because it's still quite regular with us, I think of something. We talked about this event not long ago and he told me something he hadn't told me about that happened a few months ago. So I'll place the thing, to tell you how we can still have really deep and intimate exchanges. [21-25] years ago, when he met me, he was with someone he had just left. So in addition, I came after someone he had just left. And this person had a kind of fragility. But it doesn't matter, it's mostly about what will happen you'll understand. So, with [partner] things moved quickly, I became a mother quickly. [Redacted]. I tried to be by his side, but I was myself with... I admit that at that time it wasn't easy. I had just become a mother. And he recently met a girl he knew and who knew [ex-partner], so this person who was this old friend. And when she recognized him. She said to him, "Do you remember? I lived in the same village as [ex-partner]." And it quite threw him that she talked to him like that. That she reminded him of this person, in that way. And we talked about what he felt at the time. He confided in me a bit more, about the guilt he had felt, about the sorrow he had, the feeling that he... Yes. About the sorrow he felt, yeah. And so there you go. That's something. And I talked to him about my guilt too that I hadn't told him too much about at the time. And we were able to talk about it with a lot of sincerity. There you go. It's a fairly recent example. We can also talk about more intimate things, about our fantasies. We talk about things like that quite easily too.

Speaker 1 [01:30:06] You bring up the notion of sexuality, you've mentioned it several times during this interview, and it's true that it is a constitutive dimension of couple relationships and that it can be more or less important in a relationship. What about it for you?

Speaker 2 [01:30:24] I think it is essential nonetheless. It is very important. In the sense that, it transcends. In fact, sexuality also transcends through the body everything that words won't necessarily suffice to say. So starting from that - in any case if we consider it like that - starting from there, making the body... You see, once again words, but making the body with the other, that's sexuality. It's about totally abandoning yourself in your body, in your being, in what is most profound in you. And it's about giving pleasure to the other and receiving the other. Yes. It was also a beautiful act of love through sexuality.

Speaker 1 [01:31:16] It's an act of love?

Speaker 2 [01:31:17] Yes. Well, we can have sex without love, I think we've all done it. And it's not necessarily horrible, far from it. But when there's love, it's rather better.

Speaker 1 [01:31:29] Yes, you talked to me about this notion of abandonment, of surrendering.

Speaker 2 [01:31:34] Yes, completely yes. That is to say that we are capable of... Well, we won't forbid ourselves anything in fact. We will be able to have fun freely. And maybe go out a little bit of oneself too... In sexuality, there is also something instinctive, less cerebral, that feels

good. We often talk about, especially in our time, returning to nature, returning to the essential. To a well-understood, well-lived sexuality. It's exactly that in fact. It's going to the essential, knowing what feels good to your body, knowing what feels good to the other, and taking and receiving, I mean, there's nothing more. And we can do lots of things. As long as everything is done, of course, with respect, in freedom of thought, in acceptance, and in agreement. There you go. With consent, we can really allow ourselves anything.

Speaker 1 [01:33:01] If I understand correctly what you are describing, it's also about sexuality as a form of authenticity and non-formalized sincerity.

Speaker 2 [01:33:13] Yes, something that also allows, certainly, sometimes to let go. To be raw, but raw not brutal, to be in the simplest expression. Since we are both people who like to talk, who like to think, the counterpart of that is being... And it's him who maybe really initiated me - even though I still liked the... I already found it important in a couple's life - but with [partner], it took on another dimension. Because there you go, he's someone who's particularly at ease with the subject (laugh) and for whom it is very important. So yes, it allows - we were talking earlier about balance, it balances too I think.

Speaker 1 [01:34:21] It balances.

Speaker 2 [01:34:22] Yes. When there is no more - so in sexuality I include the carnal side, huh. It's not the act itself, of course. It's really everything related to... If you no longer have carnal contact with the other, I think there's a real imbalance that can set in. It seems really essential to me in the life of a couple. Skin-to-skin, the fact of feeling each other, touching each other, of... You see, it appeals to important senses.

Speaker 1 [01:35:03] If I understand what you are saying, there is this idea that sexuality, the carnal, is one aspect of the relationship, the other being perhaps more cerebral things, understanding, etc., and these two things are united by what is common between them, that is to say, communication.

Speaker 2 [01:35:23] Yes, completely. Because you say a lot of things through the body. The more you are accomplices, the more you will understand what pleases the other, what makes them feel good. The exchange will be easier. And then we might allow ourselves things we would never have allowed ourselves before. There you go, when you're really comfortable with the other, you lift taboos, necessarily... Censures, prohibitions. So prohibitions, careful I'm not talking about crazy stuff... But there you go, in any case, we open up a lot more.

Speaker 1 [01:36:08] It's also a way to better know the other. And then quite simply, very prosaically, to take pleasure.

Speaker 2 [01:36:13] There you go exactly. And to give it.

Speaker 1 [01:36:21] Currently, roughly, what would be the frequency of your sexual relations?

Speaker 2 [01:36:26] Oh well, once a day? One to two times a day, yeah, once a day, during holidays, every day.

Speaker 1 [01:36:35] And more generally, because holidays can be special moments.

Speaker 2 [01:36:40] Oh well, it's still 2 to 3 times a week, minimum.

Speaker 1 [01:36:46] Would you say you are satisfied with your sex life?

Speaker 2 [01:36:49] Yes, yes, yes, yes. The more it goes, the better it goes.

Speaker 1 [01:36:59] For what reason are you satisfied with your sex life?

Speaker 2 [01:37:04] Sorry, I didn't hear?

Speaker 1 [01:37:05] For what reason are you satisfied?

Speaker 2 [01:37:16] Because I assume my own desires more than before, that I allow myself more things, and that he appreciates the fact that I am more comfortable too. There's more complicity in our exchanges. We've also experimented with other things and that has been good for our couple, for our sexual relationship, that's for sure.

Speaker 1 [01:38:04] Very well. I will share my screen with you, I will show you two items from a scale, and I would like you to answer them with me. So you tell me when you see it.

Speaker 2 [01:38:15] Oh my, the problem is I don't have my glasses, I see sunglasses, I'll see if I - no I don't see anything.

Speaker 1 [01:38:25] I will read it to you then. Of course.

Speaker 2 [01:38:28] Yes, I would appreciate that because it's super hard. [ndt: to read]

Speaker 1 [01:38:30] The first item is "In general, my partner really listens to me" and it's on a scale that goes from 1 to 9, one being not at all true, three being a little true, five being moderately true, seven being very true, and nine completely true. So the item is "In general, my partner really listens to me."

Speaker 2 [01:38:48] Oh yes, nine. Between eight and nine.

Speaker 1 [01:38:54] More eight or more nine?

Speaker 2 [01:38:55] Well, if I give him nine, I think it's still, it doesn't even leave room for progress. Let's say eight. (laugh)

Speaker 1 [01:39:02] So why eight.

Speaker 2 [01:39:03] (laugh) Because we can always improve. I still have [16-20] years to go with him at least so. (laugh) No, but it's eight or nine, it's just for the idea that, is it that we've completely... There are times when he's not completely... Let's say eight and a half.

Speaker 1 [01:39:27] So why not seven.

Speaker 2 [01:39:32] Oh because I still think he's way above compared to what I can see elsewhere. He is still... In listening to the other, he's top-notch.

Speaker 1 [01:40:35] The second item is "My partner is attentive to my needs" on the same scale from 1 to 9.

Speaker 2 [01:41:13] Attentive to my needs in general. Oh, he's at nine. He's at the maximum.

Speaker 1 [01:41:21] So why nine.

Speaker 2 [01:41:25] There it's really in what I was telling you all along in fact, it comes back to just that in the fact that he is still in the... To be well, the other must be well, so he is in a kind of great generosity, so he will be very attentive to the other. He is very attentive to the other and to their needs. So he is really... We will not say that he will necessarily put everything in place for - there are things for which not everything is possible - but listening that is sure, yeah. He is really attentive to the needs of the other.

Speaker 1 [01:42:02] Why not eight?

Speaker 2 [01:42:06] Because there, for once, I can't really find him... Well, why not eight. It plays a big part, but, because that's what really characterizes him in fact. There you go. If he has well, with me as with others, if he has a listening - he is with me particularly, strongly, I share his life - but when I hear him sometimes, and it's rare that he does remote interviews because he doesn't like it, he needs to see the person, but when I see the time he gives to the other, how he listens to the person, how he is attentive, how he is attentive to what they express, I tell myself, but he is impressive on that. So it's really what characterizes him. So I can only highlight this great quality. Again, also, considering what exists, and he really is, that's his huge strength. Attentive to the needs of the other, that is clear.

Speaker 1 [01:43:12] Very well. So how satisfied are you with your relationship? It goes from completely satisfied, very dissatisfied, somewhat dissatisfied, uncertain/neutral, somewhat satisfied, very satisfied, or completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [01:43:27] I'm completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [01:43:30] So you answered me in a linguistic form, if we put this in a numerical form, that is to say in the form of a scale, zero would be not at all satisfied and ten completely satisfied. Where would you place yourself?

Speaker 2 [01:43:51] We still have things to do, so I would put... We still have a long way to go... And then a bit more temperance sometimes to find in our couple, so for that, I would put nine.

Speaker 1 [01:44:14] So why not eight for example.

Speaker 2 [01:44:17] Because we've still come a long way together. And I find that we've made a lot of progress. I also highlight this progress in our couple.

Speaker 1 [01:44:40] Very well. Listen, we are coming to the end of the interview.

Speaker 2 [01:44:43] Hm-hm.

Speaker 1 [01:44:44] Is there anything you would like to add, a dimension we may not have discussed, or something you might not have said at some point?

Speaker 2 [01:44:58] Eum... It's a shame, the word hasn't come back to me. It's not very serious because I said it differently elsewhere. But a couple is really, it's really the union - yeah I already said it but it's okay I'll say it again - of bodies, of minds, and that will make it so that we progress in life, and that it is as smooth and as beautiful as possible. There you go. That's all I would say.

Speaker 1 [01:45:43] Very well. Thank you. I'll stop the recording now.